PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #19 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · KEEPING THINGS PRIVATE

"I shouldn't confide in anyone."

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Do you keep your thoughts and feelings to yourself because you do not want to confide in anyone? Does it feel safer to carry everything on your own? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward sharing with someone safe, and to find the relief that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A confidence that was betrayed, a childhood where private things were mocked or used against us, or a home where feelings were not welcome can teach us that keeping things to ourselves is the only safe way. Privacy is a healthy value. The belief goes too far when it becomes a rule that no one can be trusted with anything.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not confiding does keep us from being exposed, so the belief seems to work. But the person misses the comfort, perspective, and prayer that come from sharing, and carries everything alone. Because nothing is shared, the belief never meets a trustworthy listener.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors wise privacy: "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence." So safe people exist, and we can seek them. "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out." "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed." And God Himself invites us: "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge." We can begin with God, then share a little at a time with someone who has earned trust.

> *"Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge." (Psalm 62:8)*

Also see

> "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence." (Proverbs 11:13)

> "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out." (Proverbs 20:5)

> "Oil and incense bring joy to the heart, and the sweetness of a friend is counsel to the soul." (Proverbs 27:9)

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- It is safer to keep things to myself.
- Nobody can be trusted with my secrets.
- Sharing only makes things worse.
- I should handle my own business.
- What I say will be used against me.
- Privacy is the only protection.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must tell everyone everything or tell no one anything.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anything I share will be betrayed.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting one betrayal stand for everyone.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how a listener would react.
- Selective attention: Remembering broken confidences and forgetting kept ones.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling exposed and concluding that sharing is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me not to confide?
- Has anyone ever kept something I shared? What happened?
- What is the difference between healthy privacy and carrying everything alone?
- What signs show that a person can be trusted?
- What could I tell God, who already knows everything?
- What small thing could I share first, and with whom?
- If a friend told me they could not confide in anyone, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Privacy is wise, and so is finding a safe person to confide in. I can start with God, who hears everything, and share a little at a time with someone who has earned trust. I do not have to carry it all alone.

A short prayer

Lord, You know my heart. Teach me to pour it out to You, and to find one trustworthy person to share with. Keep me from carrying everything alone. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Confession
- Friendship
- Trust
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

He Knows
Jeremy Camp

Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Just Be Held
Casting Crowns

God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

I Am Not Alone
Kari Jobe

God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus
Keith and Kristyn Getty

This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where confiding in others is avoided. Many clients have a history of breached confidences, so trust must be earned in session; clear explanations of confidentiality and its limits help. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What could I tell God, and who might be safe to tell next?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I shouldn't confide in anyone."

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Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I shouldn't confide in anyone." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I shouldn't confide in anyone."

- ☐ What happened that taught me not to confide?
- ☐ Has anyone ever kept something I shared? What happened?
- ☐ What is the difference between healthy privacy and carrying everything alone?
- ☐ What signs show that a person can be trusted?
- ☐ What could I tell God, who already knows everything?
- ☐ What small thing could I share first, and with whom?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I can pour out my heart to God.
- ☐ Trustworthy people keep confidences.
- ☐ I can share a little at a time.
- ☐ Privacy and sharing can both be wise.
- ☐ I do not have to carry everything alone.
- ☐ A friend's counsel is sweet to the soul.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 62:8
  "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge."
- ☐ Proverbs 11:13
  "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence."
- ☐ Proverbs 20:5
  "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:9
  "Oil and incense bring joy to the heart, and the sweetness of a friend is counsel to the soul."

☐ Galatians 6:2
“Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

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5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Confession. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Write a letter to God telling Him everything on your heart.
- ☐ List the safest people you know and what makes them safe.
- ☐ Share one small, low-risk thing with a safe person, and note how they responded.
- ☐ Ask a trusted person what helps them feel safe confiding in others.
- ☐ Notice a time someone kept your confidence.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to bring one trustworthy listener into your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known by God and held in His care.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I shouldn't confide in anyone.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I can pour out my heart to God and, in time, share a little with someone safe. I do not have to carry it all alone.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 62:8

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for hearing everything. Give me a trustworthy listener, and help me share a little at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.